



★ SPECIAL REPORT ★

THE EDITORIAL STYLE GUIDE

Same tokens, same voice, same loom —

SET LIKE A RESEARCH PROSPECTUS

500 ANSWERED · FOURTEEN EXHIBITS
ONE FORMATTING STANDARD

SECOND EDITION · AUGUST 2026 · FOR THE LEAD RESEARCHER

ABSTRACT

This edition codifies what the report already does well — the Prologue's way of breaking long text, the Underloom's flow between stations, the theme engine's legal color pairs — and tightens what reads as a wall: measure, apparatus, pacing, and wayfinding. It changes no theme, token, or color. Faces and palettes bind to the engine's slots, so every rule survives a theme switch, a typeface switch, and the colorblind override. It also holds on phones and tablets: every layout in this guide names its small-screen form.

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§ 1

VOICE & REGISTER

The report's authority comes from restraint. Its register sits where three traditions meet, and every block of copy should be traceable to one of them.

MUSEUM CATALOG	ACADEMIC JOURNAL	DATA JOURNALISM
Wall text, plates, exhibits. Short declarative framing beside the object; the object does the persuading.	Front matter, numbered plates, reported statistics, visible methods. Every claim carries its apparatus.	Pacing. One idea per scroll-beat, breathing room around big numbers, momentum between stations.
1.1	Summarize, never argue. The report states what respondents said; it does not litigate. Where the researcher editorializes, the block is labeled as such — a signed letter, a marked aside. Opinion gets a visible frame; data does not.	
1.2	The Prologue is the pattern. The researcher's letter already shows how long text breaks: short paragraphs, a red-ruled pull quote at the turn, a crosshead ("Grassroots Outreach") every three to four paragraphs, an artifact floated in the margin, a signature to close. Any block longer than four paragraphs adopts this kit — no unbroken column of prose anywhere in the report.	
1.3	Wall text is two sentences. Strong lead, no throat-clearing. Openers of the form <i>"Now that you've seen...,"</i> <i>"Before we get into...,"</i> <i>"To establish a baseline..."</i> are struck; the reader is already here. The standfirst (§ 2, role D) carries the setup at ≤ 30 words — centered is fine; long is not.	
1.4	One idea per block; numbers live in figures. A paragraph holding two findings is two paragraphs — or one paragraph and one figure. A sentence carries at most one statistic; the figure and its caption carry the rest. Prose blocks inside a card cap at two.	
1.5	Fixed nomenclature. Cohorts are proper nouns: <i>Intact</i> , <i>Circumcised</i> , <i>Restoring</i> , <i>Observer & Ally</i> . Readers follow a <i>pathway</i> , never apply a <i>filter</i> ; they enter an <i>exhibit</i> , never view a <i>chart</i> ; people are <i>respondents</i> , never <i>users</i> . Sensation metrics keep their instrument names: Mobile skin, Light touch, Variety, Duration, Ease, Intensity.	



§ 2

THE TYPE SYSTEM

Roles bind to the theme engine's slots — display, body, condensed, mono — never to a family. The Bureau pairing and the mid-century Tomorrow pairing both wear every role below; so do the dyslexic and easter-egg overrides, automatically.

ROLE	SPECIMEN – BUREAU / TOMORROW	SPECIFICATION
A PULL STAT	d=2.48 d = 2.48	--f-display, heaviest weight clamp(48px, 8vw, 88px) / 1.0 tabular figures · ≤ 1 per act (§ 5.4)
B ACT HEADLINE	The Pleasure Gap THE PLEASURE GAP	--f-display 700–800 44.8px / 1.1 · may center names the finding, not the chart
C ACT LABEL / KICKER	ACT I · SENSATION § 3.1 · STATION KICKER	--f-condensed 700, CAPS ACT LEVEL: 16px / +0.26em – a true heading, up from 11.5px station level: 11.5px / +0.24em
D STANDFIRST	Every respondent rated six sensation metrics before the survey revealed its subject.	--f-body 300 19.2px / 1.6 · measure 620px ≤ 2 sentences, ≤ 30 words · may center
E BODY	The gliding mechanism reduces friction, so stamina and comfort hold longer without irritation.	--f-body 400 (300 ≥ 15px on dark) 15.2px / 1.75 · measure ≤ 68ch left-set, ragged right
F CROSSHEAD	GRASSROOTS OUTREACH	--f-display 700, CAPS, goldBright 13.6px / 1.2 · +0.08–0.12em every 3–4 paragraphs of long prose (1.2)
G CARD TITLE	★ FROM THE LEAD RESEARCHER	--f-display 700, CAPS +0.14em 12.5px minimum red star prefix, fixed
H DATA / REFS	n = 204 · p < .001 ★★★	JetBrains Mono 600 (all themes) floor 9.6px – nothing smaller tabular + lining, always
I CAPTION	SURVEY RECRUITMENT FLYERS, 2024	--f-condensed 600, CAPS 10px / 1.4 · +0.08em · dim

2.1 **Faces are theme slots.** Nothing outside the mono role hard-codes a family. Bureau (Playfair · Barlow · Barlow Condensed) is the default; Tomorrow (Josefin Sans · Outfit) is the house mid-century pairing; the dyslexic override (Lexend everywhere) and the terminal easter eggs inherit every role, size, and rule without exception.

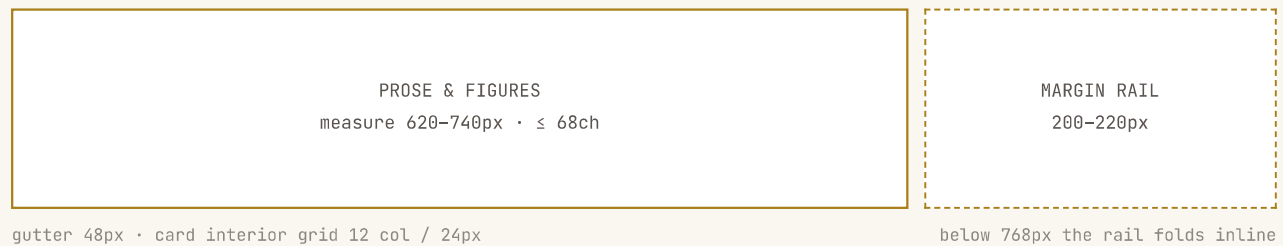
-
- 2.2 The 9.6px floor.** No character renders below 0.6rem on any device. Exhibit refs at 0.52rem and benchmark axis labels at 0.44–0.48rem rise to the floor. Small is not refined — small is small.
-
- 2.3 Numbers set flush.** `tabular-nums` on every ledger, table, and chart value; a thin space either side of = and < in every statistic: $d = 2.48$, $p < .001$, $n = 344$.
-
- 2.4 True punctuation.** Curly quotes and apostrophes in all editorial text; straight quotes only inside mono settings. Ranges take an en dash (1970–1990); asides take spaced en dashes or parentheses, never a hyphen.
-

§ 3

GRID, MEASURE & THE SMALL SCREEN

The scroll feels endless because everything occupies one column at one width. The fix is lateral — and every lateral move names its collapse on tablet and phone.

THE STATION GRID · 960PX CONTAINER



- 3.1 Two-column analysis.** Card prose beyond one paragraph sets in two real CSS columns (`column-count:2`; `column-gap:3rem`) with a dotted column rule — the Bureau's leader dots turned vertical. One column below 768px. Demonstration:

The intact penis functions as a self-lubricating system with a natural gliding mechanism. Removal of that tissue introduces a friction-based mechanic, and the difference surfaces in daily routine: most intact respondents never purchase artificial lubricant, while a

plurality of circumcised respondents report always needing it. Set in a single centered column this passage occupies six lines and reads as filler; set here it occupies three and reads as analysis.

- 3.2 The margin-note rail.** Secondary material — definitions, sample caveats, cross-references, the docent prompt — moves to a 200px right rail beside the block it annotates. The recruitment-flyer float in the Prologue is already this pattern; the rail makes it systematic. Below 768px, notes fold inline between paragraphs, keeping their gold crossbar.

The main measure keeps moving while the rail carries the aside. A reader who wants the definition finds it exactly level with the claim; a reader who doesn't loses nothing. Notes set in the body face at 12px over a 2px gold crossbar, never boxed.

MARGIN NOTE

"Mobile skin" is the survey's term for gliding-action pleasure — the question asked respondents to rate it from 1 to 5.

- 3.3 Measure is law; display may center.** Prose never exceeds 68 characters per line, whatever the card width. Act labels, headlines, kickers, standfirsts, pull stats, and captions may center — that is the house look and it stays. Centered *running prose* caps at two lines; anything longer sets left.

3.4 One system, three widths. Every pattern in this guide has a named form at each width — nothing is "desktop only":

PATTERN	DESKTOP ≥ 960	TABLET 768-960	PHONE < 768
Analysis columns	2 columns + dotted rule	2 columns	1 column
Margin rail	200px right rail	180px rail	folds inline, keeps crossbar
Sensation chart	grouped vertical bars	vertical, scrollable	horizontal bars (as built)
Mirror quote grid	2-up, paired	2-up	stacked, pairs adjacent
Act folio	full bar + ticks + count	full bar	act № + count only
Progress rail / TOC	left rail, sticky	collapsed to top	folio only

3.5 Touch is first-class. Every interactive element — cohort pills, toggles, docent markers, share buttons — hits at least 44 × 44px on touch devices. Hover-only meaning is banned: tooltips become tap-to-pin, and any value revealed on hover is also printed in the figure or its caption.



§ 4

ANATOMY OF A STATION

Every station sets from the same parts in the same order. Parts may be omitted, never reordered. The spacing column is the whitespace budget — trust it and resist filling it.

00	THE UNDERLOOM	Beneath everything: 64 threads in the station's formation (§ 7.5). The theme's background always shows through.	fixed canvas
01	ACT FOLIO	Running act bar with position counter (§ 7.2). Opens the act, not each card.	⌵ 64px below
02	ACT LABEL	Role C at act scale — 16px caps in the act's color, centered, a true heading. Dotted rule above, as built.	⌵ 8px
03	HEADLINE	Role B, centered. Names the finding where one exists ("The Pleasure Gap").	⌵ 16px
04	STANDFIRST	Role D, ≤ 30 words. The only preamble permitted; replaces the long intro paragraph.	⌵ 32px
05	FIGURE PLATE	The ruled card: star title, plate number, the figure, caption, source line. The data moment — nothing competes beside it.	⌵ 32px
06	ANALYSIS	≤ 2 paragraphs, two-column when both run (§ 3.1), a crosshead if longer (1.2).	⌵ 24px
07	MARGIN NOTE	Rail material (§ 3.2): definitions, caveats, docent prompt. Optional.	level w/ 06
08	VOICES	Paired testimony cards (§ 6). Only where the station's data is experiential.	⌵ 24px
09	RESEARCHER NOTE	Collapsed academic detail on screen; true footnote in print (§ 8.3).	⌵ 16px
10	EXHIBIT PORTAL	The tinted "Enter Exhibit" foot. One per station, always last — the only call to action.	closes card

FIG. 4-A – THE CANONICAL STATION STACK. SPACING COLUMN = VERTICAL RHYTHM BUDGET, DESKTOP.



§ 5

NUMBERS & STATISTICAL STYLE

A number is either display or evidence. Display numbers earn the biggest type on the page; evidence numbers wear mono and carry their apparatus. Nothing in between.

QUANTITY	SET AS	RULE
Scale means	4.47 vs 1.96	Two decimals, always paired with n.
Effect size	d = 2.48 ★★★	Two decimals; stars per 5.3; magnitude word optional after ("enormous").
Significance	p < .001	Threshold form only; no leading zero; never raw exponents in editorial text.
Percentages	86% · 6.3%	Integers at 10 and above; one decimal below 10.
Samples	n = 204	Lowercase mono n; per-cohort n on every figure (5.2).
Intervals	95% CI [4.34, 4.61]	Brackets, comma-space; footnote apparatus only.
Counts in prose	Five hundred answered; 433 flow to "Keep Intact."	Spell to open a sentence; figures elsewhere.

- 5.1 **The statistical signature.** Every figure closes with one mono line in fixed order — test, effect, significance, sample:

WELCH'S t, TWO-TAILED · d = 2.48 · p < .001 · n = 140/204
- 5.2 **No naked charts.** A figure without per-cohort n, a source line, and a plate number is not done. The chart itself stays exactly as designed — the apparatus dresses it (§ 9 shows the Pleasure Gap kept and dressed).
- 5.3 **Stars are earned and fixed.** ★ p < .05 · ★★ p < .01 · ★★★ p < .001, set in the finding's semantic color. The significance scale never borrows the masthead's red star or the gold accent — decoration and evidence stay distinguishable.

5.4 Pull-stat budget: one per act. A huge number, one quiet line, and whitespace — the device inflates instantly. One per act, four per report, and the number shown must be the act's single most defensible statistic. Count-up animation is screen behavior; frozen values in print.

5.5 Benchmarks travel with big claims. Any $d \geq 1.0$ shown as display type is accompanied — in plate or margin note — by the benchmark scale: aspirin→heart attack 0.07, SAT prep 0.20, psychotherapy 0.68, height difference between sexes 1.60. "Enormous" is demonstrated, not asserted.



§ 6

VOICES & QUOTATION

Two settings exist for a respondent's words. The voice card presents evidence in pairs; the pull quote grants one voice the floor. Neither is filler between charts.

SETTING 1 · VOICE CARD (PAIRED)

"I didn't know what I was missing until I understood what was taken."

– CIRCUMCISED VOICE · MILLENNIAL

"It has never once been a problem. It simply works."

– INTACT VOICE · GEN X

SETTING 2 · PULL QUOTE (SOLO)

"If someone asked you honestly how you felt about your circumcision status, what would you say?"

– THE LEAD RESEARCHER · PROLOGUE

-
- 6.1 Voice cards come in mirror pairs.** Wherever a station carries testimony from one cohort, the mirrored cohort sits beside it — the survey's signature analytical move, made visual. On phones the pair stacks but stays adjacent. A lone voice card is a pull quote wearing the wrong clothes.
-
- 6.2 The 3px border is the attribution.** Pathway color on the left edge identifies the speaker's cohort before a word is read; the byline confirms it in the cohort's color, passed through the engine's legibility check. Format is fixed: — *[Cohort] Voice · [Generation or age bracket]*. Never names, never locations.
-
- 6.3 Verbatim or not at all.** Quotes are never stitched, tightened, or paraphrased. Omissions are marked with bracketed ellipses [...]; anything else disqualifies the quote. Opening quote marks hang into the margin so the text edge stays optically flush.
-
- 6.4 One pull quote per act, red-ruled.** The italic pull quote takes the act's single most consequential sentence, over a 2px red crossbar. It shares the pull stat's budget discipline: scarcity is what makes it land.
-



§ 7

PACING, WAYFINDING & THE UNDERLOOM

"Scroll and scroll" is a wayfinding failure, not a length problem. The Table of Contents and progress rail stay; the act folio adds a running sense of position; the loom carries the flow between stations.

THE ACT FOLIO – SPECIMEN (DEEP SPACE; TOKENS ADAPT PER THEME)



FIG. 7-A – STICKY UNDER THE MASTHEAD WITHIN EACH ACT; THE PRINT RUNNING HEADER; ACT № + COUNT ONLY ON PHONES.

-
- 7.1 The screenful rule.** No viewport-height of scroll passes without a data moment — a figure, a pull stat, a voice pair, or a plate. Two consecutive prose blocks is the ceiling (1.4); a third idea earns a figure or waits. The rule holds on a phone viewport, which is where walls form first.
-
- 7.2 Act folios count position.** Every act opens with the folio bar (Fig. 7-A): act number, act title, tick gauge, position counter. Readers who know they are at 02/04 keep going; readers in an unmarked corridor stop.
-
- 7.3 The act budget.** One act = one folio, one act label, one standfirst, ≤ 3 figure plates, ≤ 1 pull stat, ≤ 1 voice pair, one portal. An act exceeding the budget is two acts — or its overflow belongs in the Appendix, which is exactly what the Appendix is for.
-
- 7.4 Breathe at the gates.** Between acts: the pull stat or divider alone at 5.5rem top / 5rem bottom padding, nothing else within its viewport. Whitespace at the act boundary is what converts "scroll and scroll" into chapters — and it is where the loom morphs.
-

7.5 The Underloom charter. The holographic loom is the report's connective tissue — 64 threads whose formation is chosen editorially per station: tartan where data crosses (Prologue, Correlations), canyon flight for the Pleasure Gap terrain, moiré for the Mirrors, pendulum for Culture & Restoration, pulsar for the Numbers, quiet for the Witnesses and Parents, flow where streams converge. Its discipline is already written into the engine and becomes law here:

- Alpha budget ≤ 0.35 — the loom glows, never competes.
 - Motion damps to 30% at scroll-rest; reduced-motion freezes it.
 - Text never rides the loom: cards and plates stay opaque above it.
 - Formations morph only in the gutters between stations.
 - Every thread color resolves through the theme tokens.
 - The theme's own background always shows through.
-



§ 8

NOTES, SOURCES & CITATIONS

A prospectus is trusted because every figure can be traced — in words a reader already knows. Three reference registers, each with a fixed, plain-language form.

REGISTER	FORM	POINTS TO
Exhibit ref	EXHIBIT 03	A live interactive exhibit in the Explore index — a real destination the reader can enter.
Plate ref	PLATE 03-A	A numbered figure within a station: station number + letter.
Question ref	ASKED: "HOW OFTEN DO YOU REQUIRE ARTIFICIAL LUBRICATION?"	The survey question itself, quoted verbatim — never an internal form code.

8.1 Plain words over codes. Internal identifiers never face the reader — no form numbers, column ids, or file names in editorial text. A reference either navigates (EXHIBIT), numbers a figure (PLATE), or quotes the instrument (ASKED). If a reference needs decoding, it is techno-babble and it goes.

8.2 The source line. Every plate's last element, one fixed form, mono at 9.6px, dim:

SOURCE: PHASE 1 FROZEN SNAPSHOT · N = 501 · SELF-SELECTED SAMPLE · ASKED: "RATE YOUR PLEASURE FROM MOBILE SKIN, 1-5" · EXHIBIT 03

8.3 Caveats live in the apparatus, once. "Self-selected, predominantly North American, non-probability" appears in the Methodology, the source line, and nowhere else. A caveat repeated in body prose reads as apology; a caveat in fixed apparatus reads as rigor. Researcher notes stay collapsed on screen and print open as numbered footnotes at the plate foot.

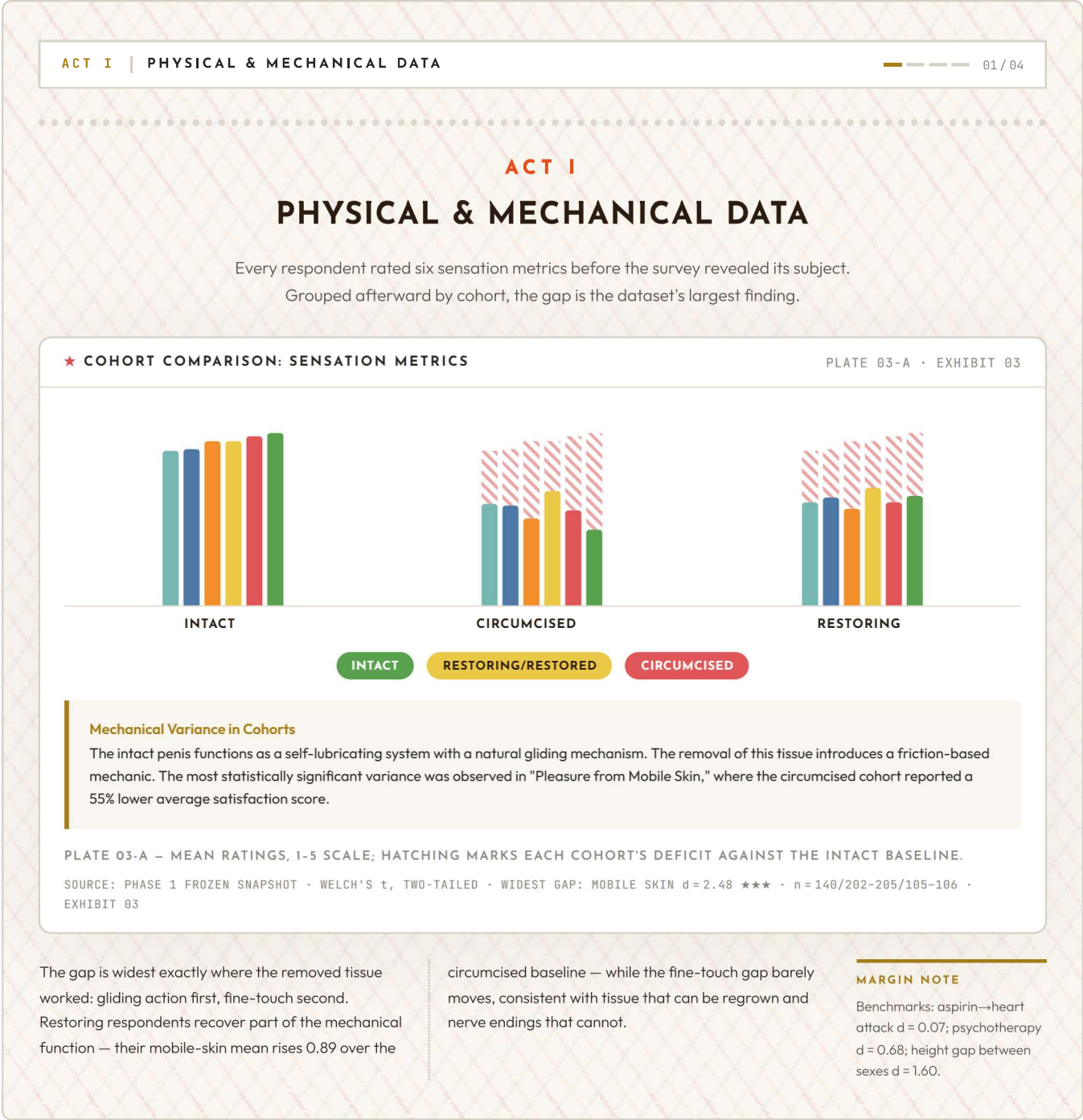
8.4 External claims get real citations. Any statement not sourced from the survey — falling U.S. circumcision rates, anatomy, history — carries a superscript marker resolving to a References block in the Appendix: author, year, publication. No orphan facts.



§ 9

STATION 03, KEPT & DRESSED

The Pleasure Gap exhibit stays exactly as designed — chart, centered headings, gold callout. The guide only dresses it: a folio above, apparatus below, and a tighter standfirst. Rendered in warm cream; every value is the frozen snapshot.



- kept: your chart, centered headings, gold callout + act folio with position (7.2)
- + act label at heading scale (§ 2, role C) + plate №, caption & source line (5.2, 8.2)
- + two-column analysis & benchmark note (3.1, 5.5) △ intro tightened 44 → 22 words (1.3)

WHAT THE GUIDE TOUCHES – AND WHAT IT LEAVES ALONE

KEPT	The grouped-bar exhibit with hatched deficits · centered act headings and dotted dividers · the gold callout · the Underloom · themes, tokens, and colors — all of it, untouched.
ADDED	Act folio with position count · act labels at heading scale · plate numbers, captions, statistical signatures, source lines · margin-note rail · benchmark scale beside big effect sizes.
TIGHTENED	Intros to ≤ 30-word standfirsts · prose blocks to two per card, two-column when both run · references to plain words · mono sizes up to the 9.6px floor.



COLOPHON

THE THEMING ENGINE ON RECORD

Nothing in this guide is a new color. Every rule binds to the engine's tokens, and the engine decides what is legal: every text-on-background pair is stepped toward a 4.5:1 contrast ratio automatically, in every theme, both modes, colorblind flag on or off.

THE LEGIBILITY LAW

No hand-picked color pairs. Ink over any surface passes through the engine's legibility check (ensureLegibleHex, target 4.5:1), which lightens or darkens the ink until it reads. Rules in this guide therefore name tokens — gold, goldBright, ghost, the pathway anchors — never hexes. The colorblind override remaps the semantic palette to the Wong set; the dyslexic override swaps every face for Lexend. Both inherit this guide whole. The engine is archived in this project at [reference/theme-engine/](#).

THEME INVENTORY – NINE LIVERIES • TWO MODES, THREE EASTER EGGS

THEME	MODE	BG · CARD · TEXT · GOLD · RED · BLUE	CHARACTER
Standard	dark		Deep space — the report default
	light		Warm cream — this guide's dress
Vaporwave	dark		Neon grid
	light		Lavender pastel
Evergreen	dark		Forest & amber; source of the pathway anchors
	light		Sage
Ocean	dark		Acadia night
	light		Coastal day
Amber	dark		Bronze & teak
	light		Sunroom — source of this guide's hot orange
Paper	dark		Sepia press
	light		Parchment
Pueblo	dark		Terracotta & turquoise
	light		Adobe noon
Brick	dark		Industrial kiln
	light		Rose quarry
Mono	dark		Ink on jet; halftone dots; single-hue charts
	light		Newsprint
Frodo · Agnes · Woz	eggs		C64 · Workbench · Apple II — terminal faces, radius zero

Typeface liveries: Bureau (Playfair Display · Barlow · Barlow Condensed, default) · Tomorrow (Josefin Sans · Outfit — this guide's dress) · Dyslexic override (Lexend throughout) · terminal eggs (VT323 / JetBrains Mono). Colorblind flag remaps semantics and pathways to the Wong palette.

UNIVERSAL PATHWAY ANCHORS

- Intact #2a9d8f
- Circumcised #e76f51
- Restoring #e9c46a
- Observer & Ally #7868b8
- Rainbow rule masthead / footer only

Some liveries remap the pathway trio (Standard light borrows its categorical set; Mono flattens to ink). Rules bind to the token, never the hex — the anchors above are the universal values this guide's plates render.

